

Voice XML

This is an emerging Web-based markup language for representing human-computer dialogues. It allows the development of applications that support the use of telephones and similar voice-based devices to access content, including Internet content, with speech commands. It makes use of improvements in computer-based speech recognition and text-to-speech synthesis and the growth in the capabilities of the Web.

VoiceXML is similar in nature to HTML but requires the use of a voice browser with audio output and input. The VoiceXML Forum, a consortium of over 300 companies, has introduced the VoiceXML 1.0 specification, which will now be further developed by the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C).

The typical VoiceXML browser will run on a specialised voice gateway node that is connected both to the PSTN and the Internet. It can be used for information retrieval, e-commerce, telephone services and perhaps most importantly for future unified messaging applications.

cost savings and it involves the convergence of voice, fax, video and data communication services over IP networks. But while the present telephone infrastructure exists, it is necessary to ensure that data can flow from one type of network to another. The most practical interim solution is for service providers to set up voice gateways that would integrate with the existing data networks.

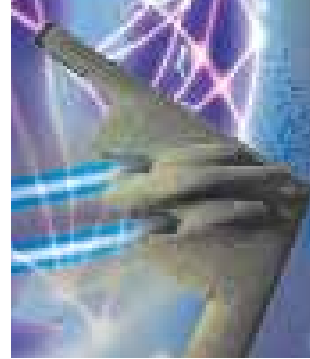
VoIP or voice over Internet protocol is a technology that a lot of us are already familiar

with. This allows us to make voice calls over the Internet. Services offered by Web sites such as Net2Phone have allowed people to make telephone calls via computers, either to other computers or to conventional telephone instruments. Here, the voice data travels from your PC through the regular telephone network into the Internet. It then re-enters the analog telephone network before terminating at the recipient's PC or telephone.

Unified messaging, which involves the access of voice, fax, and regular text messages as objects in a single mailbox, is another application that requires the flow of information across heterogeneous networks. The messages can be viewed either with a regular e-mail client or by telephone. PC users can open and play back voice messages while fax images can be viewed, stored or printed. Access to the same mailbox is possible by telephone and e-mail notes in text form are converted into audio files by speech-to-text conversion software and played back. VoiceXML (www.voicexml.org) is a Web-based, HTML-like markup language that will allow developers to build applications that make this kind of information retrieval possible.

Looking ahead

With the rapidly evolving Internet there will be reduced restrictions in communication. Already the world has come closer without the globe shrinking. But the virtual tour does not end as yet. There will be more encounters with newer technologies and developments in the silently developing parallel world. Who knows, the next technology being discussed could be the functioning of the Internet in the outer space network systems and interacting with our neighbouring aliens! 



<http://www>

Advanced International Networks

www.apan.net

More on the APAN (Asia-Pacific Advanced Network)

www.internet-2.org.il

IUCC (Israel Inter-University Computation Center)

www.renater.fr

RENATER2 (France Research and Education Network)

www.singaren.net.sg

SingAREN (Singapore Advanced Research and Education Network)

www.surfnet.nl

SURFnet (The Netherlands Research and Education Network)

www.internet2.edu

More in the Internet2 project

1/3 rd Strip AD